CHIP CATEGORY REVIEW

Category Strategy Insights & Trial Store Evaluation

Prepared for Julia — Strategic Plan Input, Next Half Year

Data source: Loyalty transaction data (Jul 2018 - Jun 2019) · 264,836 transactions

THE ANSWER — UP FRONT

Two decisions, two clear answers

1

Category Strategy

Focus the next 6 months on the brands, pack sizes, and customers that already drive the category — 5 brands generate 59% of sales, 175g/150g/134g packs drive 51%, and Older Singles/Couples & Retirees are the highest-value segments. Grow existing strength before chasing new ranges.

2

Trial Store Result

The trial worked in 2 of 3 stores. Stores 77 and 88 sold significantly more than their matched control stores after the trial began — recommend rolling out to similar stores. Store 86 showed no consistent uplift and should not be scaled as-is.

ROADMAP

How this report is organized

Each section leads with its conclusion, then shows the evidence behind it — read the headline first, drill into the chart only if you need to.

A

Category Strategy — 3 Insights

Brand concentration, customer value by lifestage, seasonal demand pattern.

B

Trial Store Evaluation — 3 Stores

Statistical comparison of stores 77, 86 and 88 against matched control stores.

C

Recommendations & Next Steps

What to action now for the next half-year category plan.

SECTION A

Category Strategy Insights

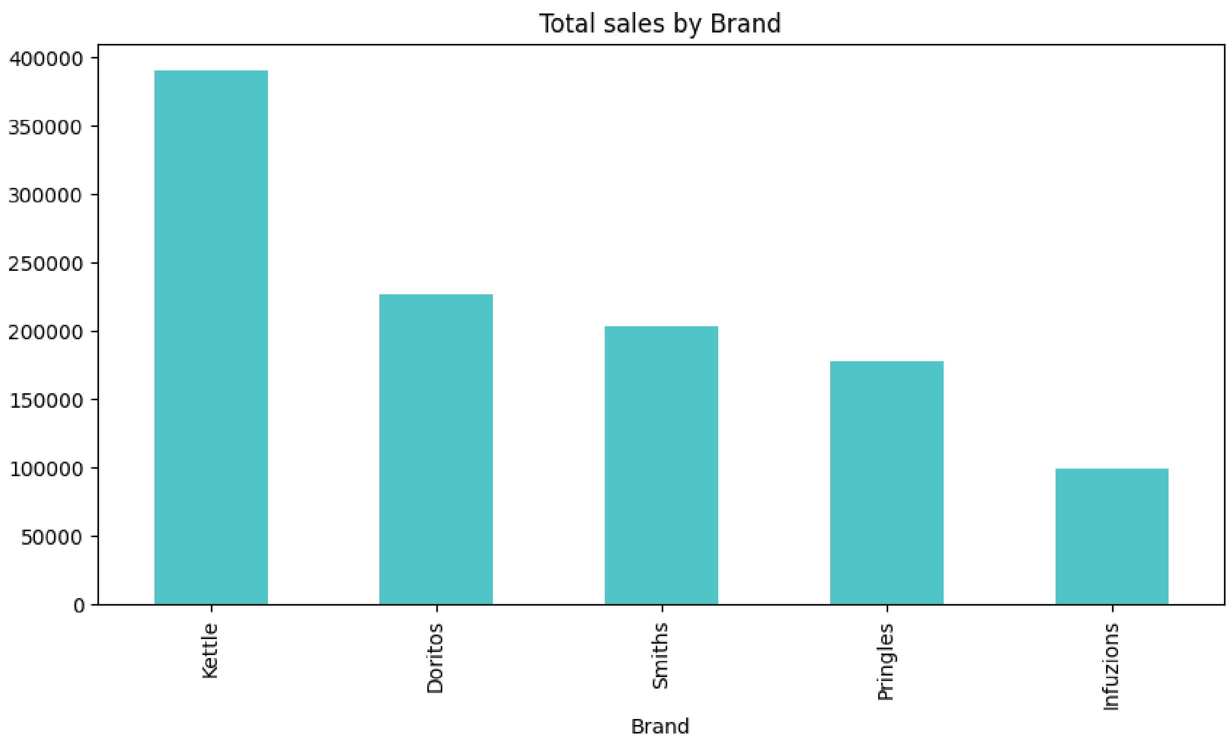
What the last 12 months of transaction data say about where to focus

Sales are concentrated in a handful of brands

60%

of total chip sales (₹1.06M of ₹1.81M) comes from just 5 brands.

- Kettle alone drives 22% of category sales — more than the next two brands combined.
- Doritos, Smiths and Pringles round out a top-4 that most shoppers already reach for.
- **So what: prioritize shelf space, promo budget and stock cover on these brands first.**



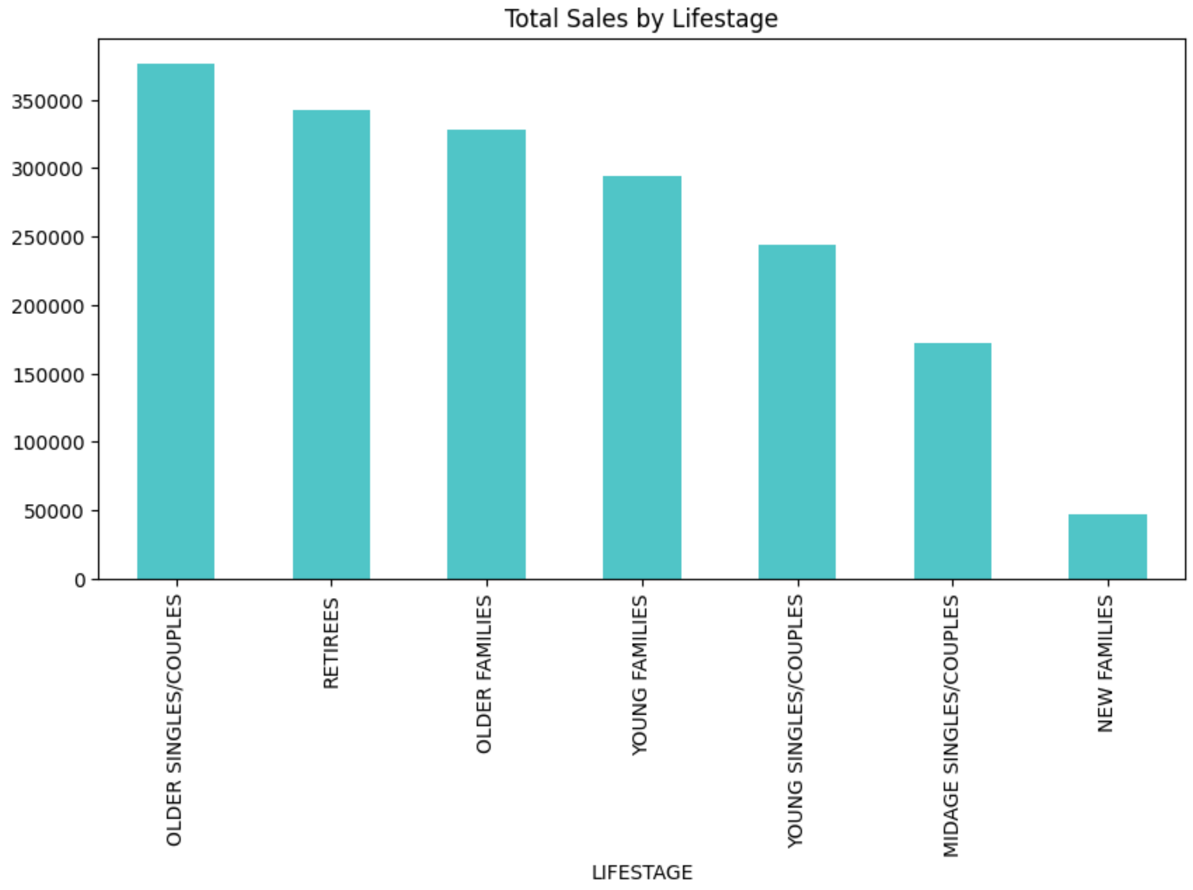
Total sales by brand (top 5 of 25 brands) — from analysis notebook

Older, established households are the highest-value customers

Top 3

lifestage segments contribute over half of category sales.

- Older Singles/Couples, Retirees and Older Families are the top 3 segments — all lower time-pressure, habitual snack buyers.
- New Families spend the least, likely smaller basket size and lower snack frequency.
- **So what: tailor pack formats and in-store placement toward these core segments rather than a one-size campaign.**



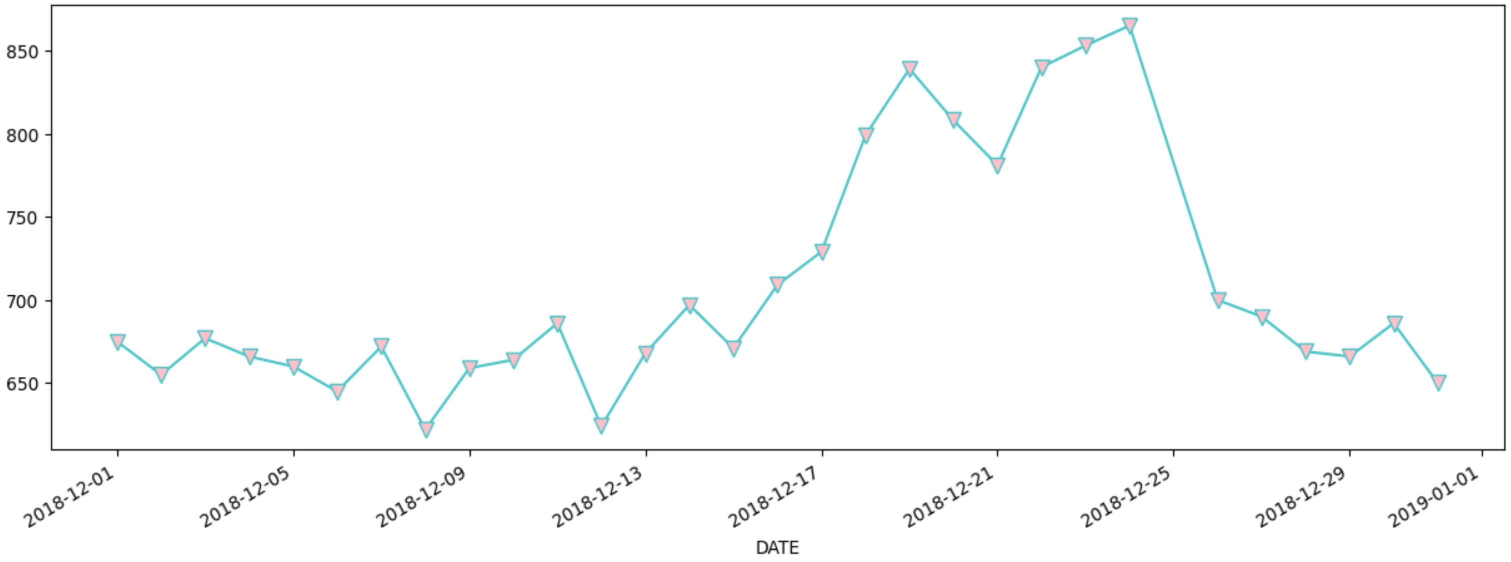
Total sales by customer lifestage — from analysis notebook

Demand spikes sharply around Christmas

+30%

jump in daily transactions in the two weeks before Christmas vs. early December.

- Daily transactions climb from ~650/day in early December to a peak of ~865/day on Dec 24.
- Volume drops sharply right after Christmas and returns to baseline by early January.
- **So what: lock in supplier stock and promo calendars for early-to-mid December well ahead of the half-year plan.**



Daily transaction count, December 2018 — from analysis notebook

What this means for the half-year category plan

1

Protect the core

Guarantee shelf space & stock cover for Kettle, Doritos, Smiths, Pringles, Infuzions and the 175g/150g/134g pack sizes.

2

Target by lifestage

Build loyalty offers around Older Singles/Couples, Retirees and Older Families — the segments already spending the most.

3

Plan for December

Increase supply and promo intensity from early December, tapering immediately after Christmas.

SECTION B

Trial Store Evaluation

Did the store trial (Stores 77, 86, 88) actually lift sales?

We compared each trial store to its closest twin

1

Find a control store

For each trial store, we found the store with the most similar pre-trial sales pattern and customer count (Feb 2019 was trial start).

2

Scale it to match

The control store's sales were scaled to the trial store's baseline, so both start from the same level before the trial.

3

Test the gap

After the trial began, we measured the % difference each month and checked if it was outside the normal range of month-to-month variation (95% confidence).

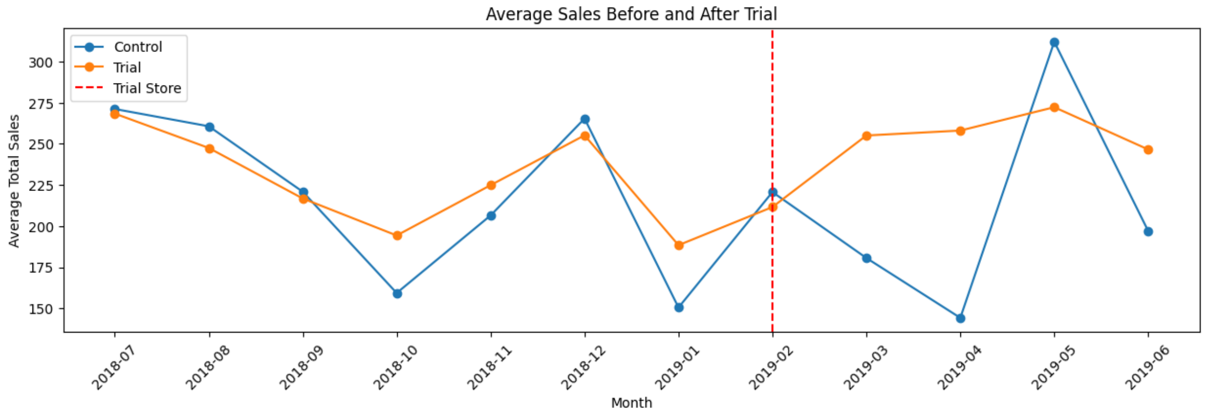
Plain-English read: if the trial store's sales line moves clearly above the control store's line — and stays outside the shaded confidence band on our charts — the trial had a real effect, not just normal noise.

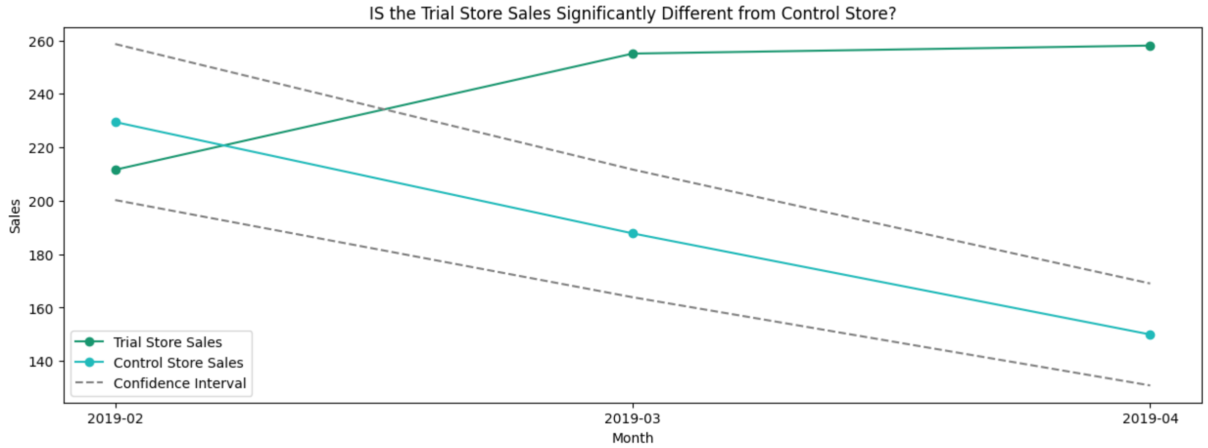
STORE 77 VS. CONTROL STORE 233

Store 77: sales pulled ahead of control after the trial

RESULT: POSITIVE

- Trial and control tracked closely before Feb 2019.
- From March 2019, trial sales stayed consistently higher, while control sales became more volatile.
- April 2019 showed a statistically significant gap (~72% above scaled control).
- **So what: this store profile is a good candidate to scale the trial format to.**



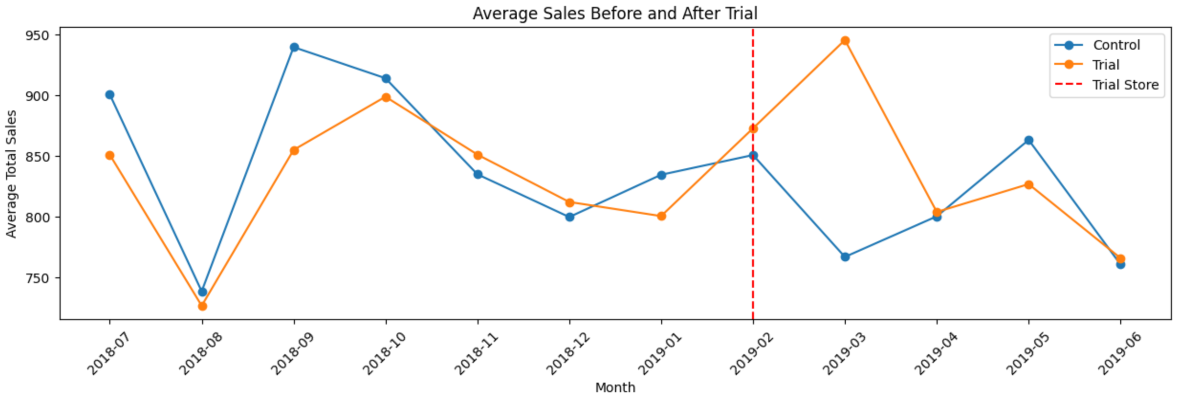


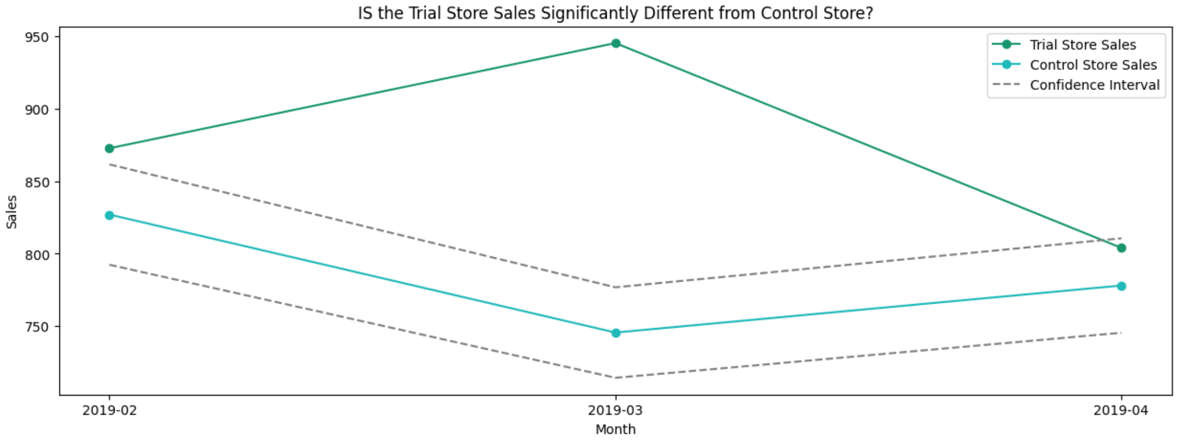
Monthly sales, Store 77 (Trial) vs. Store 233 (Control) — from analysis notebook

Store 86: no consistent uplift versus control

RESULT: INCONCLUSIVE

- Trial store spiked in March 2019 but fell back in line with control by April-June.
- Only 1 of the 3 post-trial months showed a statistically significant gap.
- Overall pattern looks close to normal month-to-month variation, not a sustained lift.
- **So what: don't scale this format based on Store 86 alone — investigate what differed from Stores 77 & 88.**



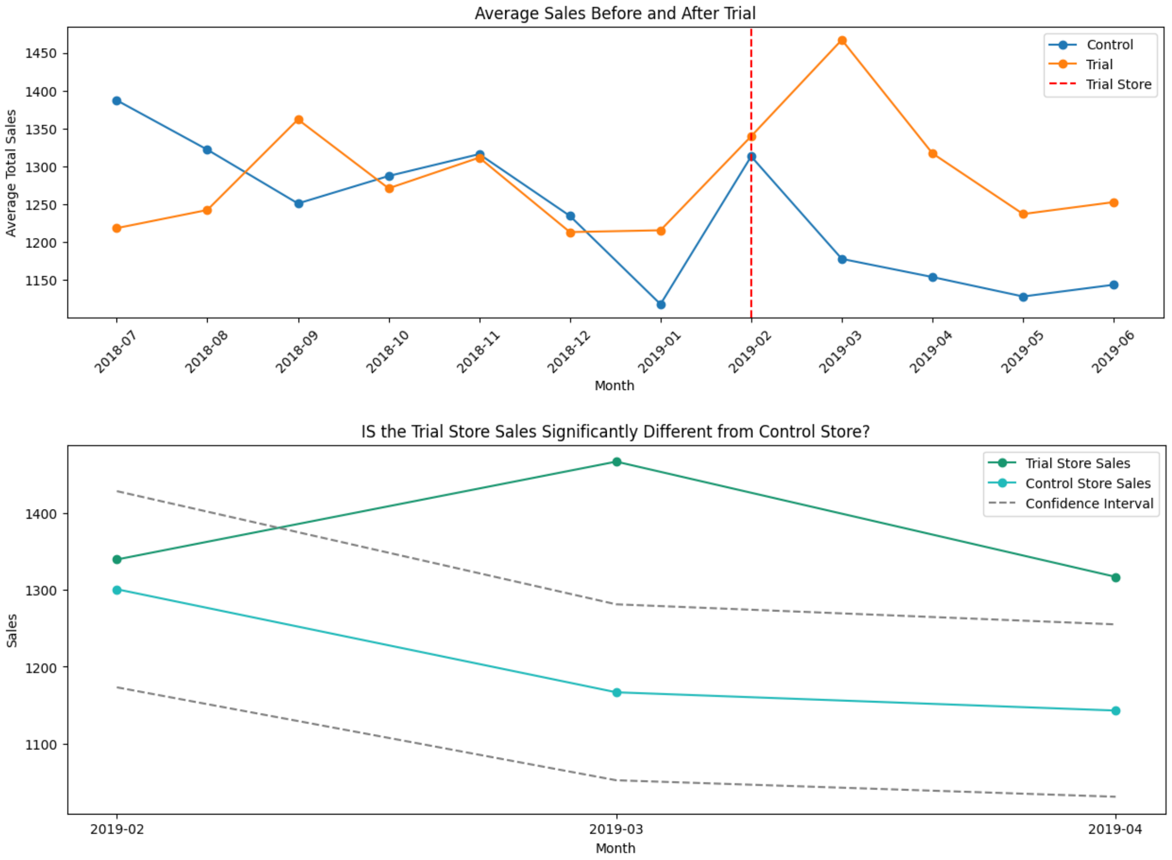


Monthly sales, Store 86 (Trial) vs. Store 155 (Control) — from analysis notebook

Store 88: the strongest result of the three stores

RESULT: POSITIVE

- Trial sales rose well above control immediately after Feb 2019, peaking in March.
- March 2019 gap was large and statistically significant (~26% above scaled control).
- Trial sales stayed above control through April-June, even as the gap narrowed.
- **So what: strongest evidence store for scaling the trial concept.**



Monthly sales, Store 88 (Trial) vs. Store 237 (Control) — from analysis notebook

RECOMMENDATIONS

What I recommend for the next half-year

Category Plan

- Protect shelf & stock priority for the top 5 brands and top 3 pack sizes.
- Build loyalty/promo programs around Older Singles/Couples, Retirees, Older Families.
- Scale up supply chain and promo spend for early-to-mid December.

Trial Store Rollout

- Roll out the trial format to stores with a profile similar to Stores 77 and 88.
- Hold off scaling to stores like 86 until we understand why the lift didn't hold.
- Re-run this evaluation after 1 more quarter of post-rollout data.